

Write-a-thon Summary

Welcome to the first ever Gush Adumim English Write-a-thon, and likely in all of Israel! You have 5 weeks (starting Dec 28-Feb 2) to write, write, and write!

Level	Level 1 Debut writer	Level 2 Author in Training	Level 3 Future Journalist	Level 4 Shakespeare Jr.
Number of written submissions	3	5	6-8	10 plus
Prizes	Ice Coffee	Golda Ice-Cream	Story-time Pizza Pie	Bowling Voucher and Trophy

Types of written assignments- each one must be completed in order to reach the next tier, but once Level 4 has been reached, you can make multiple submissions under the same category of your choice. Work should be checked by a teacher or parent before the final submission. Email to: ilanahecht@gmail.com or hand-in as a hard copy. Assignments can be hand-written or typed. For the longer assignments, it is preferable to type them. If you need a sample of a category to help give you ideas and to see the format, just ask.

You will have an impressive portfolio of writing to share by the end of this competition!

Level 1:

Poetry- Diamond Poem/Cinquain Opposites (separate instructions see below)

Poetry- Acrostic (separate instructions see below)

Fact and Opinion Chart- make a chart about a subject of your choice and include 5 facts and 5 opinions

Level 2:

Travel Diary/Daily Journaling- write a few sentences per day summarizing your travels or experiences, include images

Descriptive Writing- choose an image of a person, place, animal, natural scenery etc and write a very descriptive paragraph about the image. Make sure to use lots of adjectives, and answer questions about the image like who, where, what, when, why and how.

Level 3:

Advertisement- sell a service or product, include graphics/images, can be real or imaginary- 1 page flyer

Non-Fiction- Science Research Project (Animals, Planets, etc) 2-3 pages, include images and facts about a chosen subject of interest

Historical Biography- choose a famous person from history and provide a one-paged summary of their life, try to include a portrait of that person

Level 4:

Short story, fiction or true story- 2-3 pages, you can submit multiple short stories if you don't want to do a comic strip or play

Comic strip- minimum 9 columns, speech bubbles and images, can be hand-drawn or vectors from the internet

Play- write a short play with 1-3 acts, make sure to include multiple characters and determine the plot and setting

Instructions for poetry

Diamond poem 7-lines:

Samples:

Dog
Furry, Loyal
Jumping, Playing, Barking
Protector, Friend, Watcher, Observer
Scratching, Sleeping, Purring
Sneaky, Soft
Cat

Winter
Cold, White
Raining, Snowing, Snuggling
Hot Chocolate, Blanket, Swimsuit, Trampoline
Burning, Swimming, Jumping
Sun, Relaxed
Summer

Set-up:

Step 1- Come up with a pair of opposites that are things (noun-antonyms)

Step 2- Draw 7 lines (or leave space for 7 lines)

Step 3- Write the first word in the first line, and the second word in the last line (7th line)

Write/Create:

Line 1- first word of your opposite pair

Line 2- 2 words which describe line 1(adjectives)

Line 3- "ing" words (verbs), action words ending in ing, 3 words describing line 1

Line 4- 2 things connected to line 1, and 2 things connected to the word in line 7

Line 5- 3 "ing" words, (verbs) action words describing the word in line 7

Line 6- 2 words which describe line 7

Line 7- second word of your opposite pair

Acrostic:

Each letter of the word written vertically needs a start a full sentence or at least phrase with multiple words. Try to use alliteration when you can (each word starts with the same letter, see line 6-8 below) For example:

Can turn your frown upside down
Happily found in every home
Oasis, that's what you are
Count the days until I see you again
One of a kind
Lovely, leaves you longing for more
Absolutely amazing
Tempting, terrific and tasty
Excellent choice for a gift